

```

"getself staging"/getself prefix"/
bin/opera"
cp "getself staging"/getself prefix"/bin/
opera" /home/ab
chmod a+x "getself staging"/getself prefix"/
bin/opera";

mkdir -p "getself staging"/getself prefix"/
share/applications";
cat > "getself staging"/getself prefix"/
share/applications/opera.desktop" <<EOF
[Desktop Entry]
Name=Opera 10.50
Exec="getself prefix"/bin/opera"
Icon=/opt/opera/share/icons/
hicolor/32x32/apps/opera.png
Terminal=false
Type=Application
Categories=Application;Game;

EOF
}
}

```

After a meta-compilation process, mount the package, and then Opera is ready to be used!

A little more patience is required to build the Chromium browser [5], because it needs three to four more auxiliary libraries that are used only by Chromium. However, nothing is impossible! See Figure 6 for more details.

Future versions

Time does not stand still, and Igelle will develop further. New features and capabilities will be added, so it can run on multiple hardware platforms—not just x86, but also ARM and MIPS laptops. In particular, there was recently a logical bifurcation of the Igelle project into several key areas: mobile systems, servers/desktop systems, and embedded appliances—named Igelle Dash, Igelle Spark and Igelle Pulse, respectively.

There was also an interior redesign of the system's architecture. Now, if you decide to create a fully portable Igelle application or package, it will be tied to the special library *libigelle*. This library alone will later decide exactly what resources are needed for this application, and dynamically reroute the necessary requests to the required underlying libraries (see Figure 7).

What seems interesting though is a Wine suite integrated into the Igelle Pulse distribution, the primary focus of which is x86 desktops and servers. Having the Wine emulating layer allows users to run many Windows applications smoothly. Very often, many Windows programs still have

no equivalent in the Linux world; so this feature seems especially attractive to users who've migrated.

Most newbie Linux users expect several simple things from a general distribution: pre-installed office/network/collaboration applications to start with; a flexible and configurable environment; the presence of a pool of pre-packaged applications; as well as an ability to boot the system in a live mode. At the same time, to keep the distribution truly Linux, it must be LSB-compatible, and support multiple hardware platforms: x86, ARM, MIPS, PowerPC and others. The Igelle distribution was created in an effort to offer users just such a flexible working environment. With a vanilla GNU/Linux kernel and a stack of GNU/OSS applications, it's generally capable of running on all major hardware platforms that the current Linux kernel supports. Those applications that aren't yet in a pool of pre-packaged applications can be easily compiled with GCC, packaged with *sjdctl*, and mounted or unmounted, on the fly. Since Igelle provides a built-in GCC environment, every user, from the novice to the highly experienced, can easily and quickly transform their installation to suit their preferences.

Igelle's overlay mechanism lets you have a single distributed, basically packaged and unmodified ISO file, with transparently mounted software 'upgrades'. Igelle can be installed on a freshly reformatted media, or a single ISO file can be placed on an existing filesystem. The overlay concept allows for two booting modes: the normal and 'live' mode. The latter helps restore systems from an inconsistent/damaged state. This concept also allows users to access/keep personal data on already existing partitions—again, the maximum flexibility.

In short, Igelle really delivers you the flexibility to tailor your system as you please! **END** 

Resources

- [1] http://download.igelle.com/igelle/dsv/1.0/i686/iso/igelle-dsv_i686_1.0.0.iso
- [2] <http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/AUF>
- [3] <http://download.igelle.com/igelle/dsv/1.0/i686/apps/install.php>
- [4] <http://download.igelle.com/igelle/dsv/1.0/i686/apps/>
- [5] <http://build.chromium.org/buildbot/continuous/linux/LATEST/chrome-linux.zip>
- [6] http://www.igelle.com/doc/igelle_technical_overview_august_2_2010.pdf

By: Anton Borisov

The author has specialised in Linux and FOSS technologies for more than a decade. His professional spheres of interest include, but are not limited to, robotics, embedded systems, statistics and algorithmic methods.